Online Gaming and Parents' Perspectives

A survey analysis report

Product Analyst Take-Home Assignment | Task 1

Executive Summary

This report analyses a survey of 100 respondents about parents' perceptions of children's online gaming. The analysis focuses on perceived risks, potential benefits, parental rules and reported family impact. The clearest pattern is that concerns are widespread, while views on benefits are mixed. Almost all eligible respondents considered rules necessary, but reported rule practices varied. These findings describe the surveyed respondents' perceptions; they do not establish that gaming causes harm or that children are addicted.

Five findings are presented with counts and valid-response denominators. Two exploratory cross-tabulations were also examined. One did not support a proposed relationship between viewing gaming as a distraction and family frustration; the other showed a modest descriptive difference by parents' reported understanding of why their child plays. Given the small sample, unknown recruitment method and observational design, the cross-tabs are treated as exploratory rather than conclusive.

1. Problem Statement

Parents may view online gaming as a source of risk, a potential benefit, or both. The analytical problem is to identify meaningful patterns in these perceptions and communicate them clearly to a wider audience without overstating what the survey can prove. The report therefore distinguishes concerns from measured outcomes, examines reported parental practices and family impact, and makes the data's limitations explicit.

2. Objectives

- Identify three to five meaningful findings in parents' responses, going beyond isolated counts where the data permits.
- Interpret attitudes, concerns, rules and reported family impact in a balanced way.
- Explore potential relationships between selected variables without treating association as causation.
- Document relevant data limitations and possible sources of bias.
- Provide a defensible narrative that can be translated into a one-page, social-media-ready infographic.

3. Data and Methodology

3.1 Dataset and analysis population

The workbook contains 100 survey response rows and 38 columns, including response timestamp, gaming status, attitudes, fears, parental involvement, rules, family impact and demographic fields. The gaming-status response distribution is 45 "Yes", 22 "Sometimes" and 33 "No". Gaming-specific questions have 67 responses, consistent with the 45 + 22 respondents whose children play or sometimes play. The 33 blank follow-up records are therefore treated as likely skip-logic exclusions, not as negative responses. Item-level denominators are used where the number of valid responses differs.

3.2 Tools and workflow

Excel was used as the source workbook. Snowflake SQL was used to load and inspect the survey data, create a readable view, validate response counts and calculate grouped distributions and cross-tabulations. Word was used to prepare this supporting report. This report does not claim a Power BI dashboard or statistical significance testing was completed.

1. **Data loading and structure:** The SQL script defines a Snowflake database/schema, an S3 external stage and CSV file format, loads the CSV into a raw table with 38 VARCHAR columns, and creates YOURDOST_SURVEY_CLEAN by assigning readable names to those columns.
2. **Validation checks:** The SQL script includes queries for total rows, exact duplicate-row groups, gaming-status distribution, selected missing values and denominators. The expected total is 100. The actual duplicate-check output was not available for independent confirmation, so no conclusion about the duplicate count is made here.
3. **Descriptive analysis:** Counts and percentages were calculated for attitudes, fears, rule necessity, individual rule practices and family-impact measures. For readability, fear and family impact were grouped into Medium + High; agreement statements were grouped into Agree + Strongly Agree.
4. **Exploratory analysis:** Two cross-tabs compared distraction perceptions with family frustration, and reported understanding of why a child plays with family frustration. These are unadjusted descriptive comparisons; no causal model or significance test was performed.

4. Findings and Interpretation

Finding 1 — Concern about addiction is widespread

63 of 67 respondents (94.0%) reported medium or high fear that online games can be addictive. This is a strong signal of parental concern within this sample. It is not an estimate of the percentage of children who are addicted, nor does it establish the probability of addiction.

Finding 2 — Academic performance and age-inappropriate content are also prominent concerns

61 of 67 respondents (91.0%) reported medium or high fear of academic impact, and 59 of 67 (88.1%) reported medium or high fear of age-inappropriate content. These findings suggest that parental concerns extend beyond addiction. The survey measures fear, not verified academic decline or confirmed exposure to inappropriate content.

Finding 3 — Rules are widely considered necessary, but approaches differ

65 of 67 respondents (97.0%) considered rules necessary. Among respondents answering each individual item, 40 of 66 (60.6%) reported restricting game types, 35 of 66 (53.0%) reported limiting play to a fixed duration, and 35 of 66 (53.0%) reported avoiding gaming during exams. This points to broad support for boundaries, but no single practice is reported by all families. The data does not measure consistency of enforcement or effectiveness.

Finding 4 — Views on potential benefits are mixed

26 of 67 respondents (38.8%) agreed or strongly agreed that gaming can benefit children, while 25 of 67 (37.3%) were neutral. The neutral share is substantial, so the results should not be framed as either a clear endorsement or universal rejection of gaming's benefits. The survey does not establish which benefits respondents considered.

Finding 5 — Family frustration is reported, but the relationship with parental understanding is exploratory

42 of 67 respondents (62.7%) reported medium or high family frustration associated with children's gaming behaviour. In the cross-tab on understanding, 10 of 14 parents who said they did not understand why their child plays (71.4%) reported medium/high frustration, compared with 32 of 53 who said they did understand (60.4%). The difference is about 11 percentage points. The subgroup of 14 is small, and the survey cannot determine whether understanding affects frustration or whether other factors explain the difference.

5. Exploratory Cross-tab: A Relationship Not Supported

A second cross-tab compared agreement that gaming can be a distraction with reported family frustration. Among respondents who agreed or strongly agreed that gaming can be a distraction, 36 of 58 (62.1%) reported medium/high frustration. Among the comparison group (Disagree, Neutral or Strongly Disagree), 6 of 9 (66.7%) reported medium/high frustration. This comparison does not support the claim that perceiving gaming as a distraction is associated with greater frustration in this sample. The comparison group is very small (n=9), so the result is inconclusive rather than evidence that no relationship exists.

6. Data Quality, Corrections and Analytical Safeguards

- **Denominator discipline:** Gaming-specific percentages use the 67 eligible respondents, and individual rule items use their own valid-response denominators (for example, n=64 or n=66).
- **Skip logic:** The 33 blanks on gaming-specific questions align with the 33 respondents who answered "No" to gaming status. They are not automatically interpreted as disagreement.
- **Cross-tab correction:** An earlier provisional calculation for distraction versus frustration was corrected to 36/58 (62.1%) versus 6/9 (66.7%). The corrected figures do not support the initially proposed direction of association.
- **No causal claims:** All relationships are descriptive. The analysis does not adjust for potential confounders such as child age, gaming frequency or family context.
- **Cleaning scope:** The SQL view primarily renames columns. It improves readability but is not, by itself, evidence of comprehensive cleaning.
- **Unverified checks:** The duplicate-row query is present in the SQL script, but its result has not been independently verified for this report. The timestamp should also be checked before stating the survey date as definitive.

7. Limitations and Potential Biases

- **Sampling and generalisability:** The sample contains 100 respondents, but recruitment method and sampling frame are unknown. Findings cannot be assumed to represent all parents.
- **Self-report and perception:** Responses capture parental beliefs, fears and reported experiences rather than independently measured child outcomes.
- **Question framing:** Risk-focused wording may shape responses depending on question order and context. This is a potential source of bias to review, not a proven flaw without the full questionnaire context.
- **Small sample and subgroups:** Gaming-specific items have n=67. Cross-tab subgroups of n=14 and n=9 are small and sensitive to a few responses.
- **Aggregation:** Combining response categories makes the narrative concise but conceals differences in intensity. Full distributions should be retained in the working analysis.
- **Confounding and causality:** Age, frequency of gaming, household context and other factors could influence both attitudes and family impact. No causal inference is justified.
- **Time relevance and measurement quality:** The data appears to date from December 2020; verify the timestamp before publishing this date. The materials reviewed do not establish questionnaire validation or reliability.

8. Recommendations and Communication

The public-facing narrative should be: parents in this sample report substantial concern about potential risks, but their views on gaming's benefits are mixed; most consider rules necessary, while specific practices vary. A balanced infographic should lead with the most interpretable figures, show numerator/denominator labels, and avoid implying that gaming inevitably causes harm.

- Encourage families to agree on time and context-specific boundaries.
- Encourage conversations about the games children play and their online interactions.
- Revisit rules when they repeatedly create conflict, rather than presenting a blanket ban as the only solution.

These are practical recommendations informed by the themes in the survey; the dataset does not test whether these approaches improve outcomes.

9. Conclusion

The survey provides a snapshot of the responding parents' perceptions: high concern about potential risks, broad support for rules, mixed views on benefits and meaningful reported family frustration. The strongest contribution is a balanced account of those perceptions, paired with transparent denominators and limitations. The findings should not be treated as population estimates or evidence of causation.